

The Deep Learning Method

Go from skimming to actually understanding.

"Use Claude to actually understand things — not just read about them."

Ejoshi

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THE PROBLEM

You read an article about something important — AI, the economy, a health study, a historical event. You nod along. It feels interesting in the moment. Then two days later, someone brings it up in conversation and you can barely remember a thing. Not because you're not smart. Because reading and understanding are two completely different things.

We were never taught how to actually learn. School trained us to collect facts — memorize them long enough for a test, then let them go. Most people skim the same way. We move fast. We consume a lot. We retain very little. The problem isn't the volume of information. It's that we never stop to wrestle with it.

Claude changes this. Instead of passively reading, you can turn any concept into a conversation. You ask it to explain things simply. You ask it to challenge your understanding. You ask it to show you what most people get wrong. That friction — the back-and-forth — is exactly what moves information from short-term awareness into something you actually keep. This kit gives you the exact prompt to do it.

THE CLAUDE PROMPT

Copy this prompt exactly. Fill in the brackets with whatever you just read about. Run it with Claude — at claude.ai, completely free.

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I just read/heard about [topic]. I want to actually understand it, not just know it exists.
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Can you:
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1. Explain the core idea in plain language, as if I'm smart but new to this
2. Give me one concrete real-world example I can picture
3. Tell me what most people get wrong about this
4. Ask me one question to check if I understood it

HOW TO FILL IT IN

- **[topic]** — any concept, news item, or idea you recently encountered.
- Be specific. "Why interest rates affect house prices" beats "economics."
- You can paste in a headline or paragraph and say: "I just read this."
- The four-part structure makes Claude teach, not just summarize.

The situation: You saw a headline — "Fed raises interest rates again." You've heard this before but never quite understood what it means for real life. You fill in the prompt: *"I just read about why interest rates affect house prices."*

WHAT CLAUDE GIVES BACK

Plain explanation: When interest rates go up, borrowing money gets more expensive. A mortgage is borrowed money. If borrowing costs more, your monthly payment on a \$400,000 home jumps by hundreds of dollars — even though the home's price didn't change. Fewer people can afford those payments, so fewer people buy, so prices cool.

The concrete example: It's like a car rental that just doubled its daily rate. The car is the same car — but fewer people rent it because the cost to use it went up.

What most people get wrong: Higher rates don't automatically mean a bad economy. They're often a sign the economy was running too hot — rates are a cooling tool, not a punishment.

Claude's check-in question: "If interest rates dropped back down tomorrow, what do you think would happen to home prices — and why?"

YOUR TURN

Pick one thing you read or heard about this week — a headline, a podcast clip, something a friend mentioned. Something you nodded at but didn't fully get. Open Claude. Run the prompt. See what lands.

The prompt works on anything: science, finance, history, technology, health. The simpler you make the topic, the better the explanation. "Explain compound interest" beats "explain personal finance."

Try it free at ejoshi.ai

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